



# Training Techniques

Free Sample from the Complete Training Guide

# Your free sample

This is a real piece of the Training Techniques kit, not a teaser. You get the full Foundations chapter, two complete skills, and one printable page. Use them this week and see how the method feels with your own dog.

- **Foundations.** The eight rules that make every skill easier
- **Two skills.** Attention and sit, step by step
- **One printable.** Your daily five minute session plan

## Before you begin

This guide is general education, not veterinary or behavior advice. If your dog is hurt, sick, or you feel unsafe, contact your vet or a qualified professional.

# Foundations

The eight ideas here do most of the work in every skill that follows.

## 1. Behavior that pays gets repeated

Dogs do what works. If sitting earns chicken, sitting happens more. If jumping earns attention, jumping happens more. Before you ask "how do I stop this," ask "what is my dog getting out of it, and what would I rather pay for?"

## 2. Use a marker word

A marker is a short sound that tells your dog "that, right there, is what earned the treat." Most people use a bright "yes." Say it the instant your dog gets it right, then deliver the treat. To teach it, say "yes" and treat ten times in a row with no other ask. Your dog now knows the word means a reward is coming.

## 3. Timing is everything

Mark within one second of the behavior. A late marker pays for whatever your dog did next, which is often standing back up. If a skill is not improving, check your timing before anything else.

## 4. Pay with what your dog values

Match the pay to the difficulty. Kibble and praise are fine for easy work at home. Save chicken, cheese, or hot dog for new skills and big distractions.



## 5. Keep sessions short

Three to five minutes, two or three times a day. Stop while your dog still wants more. End on something your dog can do well, even if that means going back to an easy sit.

## 6. Lure it, then fade the lure

A lure is a treat held at the nose to guide your dog into position. Use it for the first few tries only. Then make the same hand motion with an empty hand, mark, and bring the treat from your pouch. A lure that stays too long becomes a bribe, and your dog learns to work only when food is showing.

## 7. Change one thing at a time

Every skill has three dials: **distance** (how far you are from your dog), **duration** (how long your dog holds the position), and **distraction** (what else is going on). Turn up one dial at a time. When you add distraction, make distance and duration easy again.

## 8. Give a release word

A release word tells your dog the job is over. "Free" and "okay" are common. Without one, your dog decides when stay ends. With one, you do.

# Two skills to start with

### Attention: "look"

- 1 Hold a treat at your side and wait. Say nothing.
- 2 The moment your dog glances at your face, mark "yes" and treat.
- 3 Repeat until the glance comes fast, then say "look" just before it happens.
- 4 Practice in every room, then the yard, then the sidewalk.

### Sit

- 1 Hold a treat at your dog's nose and move it slowly up and back over the head.
- 2 As the head goes up, the rear goes down. Mark and treat the moment it lands.
- 3 After five tries, use the same hand motion with no treat in it. Mark, then pay from your pouch.
- 4 Say "sit" just before the hand signal once your dog follows it every time.

**The full kit continues with down, stay, come, leave it, drop it, and loose leash walking.**



# Printable: Your daily session

Five minutes, once or twice a day. Print this and keep it where the treats live.

## Before you start

- ☐ Ten to fifteen pea sized treats ready
- ☐ Phone down, distractions low
- ☐ One skill chosen for today
- ☐ Dog has had a chance to potty

## Minute 1: Warm up

Ask for two or three things your dog already does well. Pay every one. This switches on the "we are working" mood.

## Minutes 2 to 4: The new work

Practice today's skill. Aim for eight to ten tries. If you get two misses in a row, make it easier. If you get five clean tries in a row, make the next one slightly harder.

## Minute 5: Finish on a win

End with one easy thing, pay well, say "all done," and play for a minute. Stopping while your dog wants more is what makes them eager tomorrow.

## After the session

- ☐ Note one thing that went well
- ☐ Note the step to start with tomorrow

| Today's skill | Step I am on | Tries | Clean |
|---------------|--------------|-------|-------|
|               |              |       |       |
|               |              |       |       |
|               |              |       |       |
|               |              |       |       |

**Short, clear, and fun. That is the whole method.**



# Ready for the whole plan?

You have just used the opening pages of the Training Techniques kit. The full kit is 20 pages and takes you from the first sit to a dog who listens anywhere. It works for puppies, adult dogs, and rescues with a past.

| In the full kit     | What it covers                                                                                   |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Basic commands      | Eight skills: look, sit, down, stay, come, leave it, drop it, and loose leash walking            |
| Behavioral training | Step by step fixes for jumping, barking, chewing, counter surfing, and mouthing                  |
| Advanced skills     | Place, door manners, hand target, and the ladder that makes skills hold up anywhere              |
| Socialization       | Reading body language, and calm confidence around people, dogs, places, and sounds               |
| Troubleshooting     | Common mistakes, quick fixes by symptom, and what to check when a skill stalls                   |
| Five printables     | Daily session plan, four week plan, weekly tracker, socialization checklist, and cue cheat sheet |

## More PS Dog Dad kits

- **Separation Anxiety Workbook.** A fourteen day plan for dogs who panic when you leave
- **When Company Comes.** A calm visitor plan for dogs who bark, lunge, or nip
- **New PS Dog Dad Starter Kit.** Your first 30 days with a rescue
- **Desert Dog.** Surviving a Coachella Valley summer with your best friend
- **Building a Reliable Recall.** A four week plan for a dog who comes when called

## How to get it

Go to [psdogdad.com](https://psdogdad.com), open Learn, and choose Training Techniques under Printable Kits. It downloads right away as a PDF you can print as many times as you like.

**You have already started. The full kit shows you what comes next.**

